



Fitdog Enrichment at Home

Better Walks Planning Guide



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Better Walks Through Sniffing

Let sniffing be the point.

Sometimes the best walk is not the longest walk. It is the walk that lets your dog decompress.

Sniff breaks

Decompression

Loose leash

Planning

TRAINER NOTE

If your dog finishes puzzles instantly, increase difficulty slowly — or add sniffing.

Start here

Dog's name

Date

Owner

Best reward

Daily outlets

Sniffing, chewing, and problem-solving are needs — not extras.

Match difficulty

Enrichment should engage, not frustrate.

Track engagement

A better walk gives your dog information, movement, and decompression.

1 Training goal

YOUR GOAL THIS WEEK

A better walk gives your dog information, movement, and decompression.

2 Lesson focus checklist

- ☐ Why sniffing matters
- ☐ Structured walks versus decompression walks
- ☐ Sniff breaks as rewards
- ☐ Reducing leash frustration
- ☐ Walk planning

Supplies needed

- Harness + leash
- Notebook (optional)



WALK PLAN · TRACK

3 Step-by-step practice plan

WALK TYPES

Structured walks teach manners. Decompression walks let sniffing be the point.

Plan one decompression walk: loose leash, no strict heel, sniffing allowed.

Mark and treat when your dog chooses to sniff — that is the reward.

Use a sniff break after a structured training rep on your next walk.

Compare: one structured walk vs. one sniff-focused walk. Log your dog's energy after.

Write one route change that gives your dog more sniff opportunities.

4 Compare your walk types

Walk type	Goal	Leash	Sniff time
Structured	Manners + training	Loose with guidance	Reward breaks only
Decompression	Calm + fulfillment	Fully loose	Most of the walk
This week			

5 5-day walk plan

Date	Walk type	Duration	Sniff time	Notes
Day 1	Decompression	20 min	Most of walk	Calmer after

D1

Decompression
Sniff-first route.

D2

Structured
Loose leash + cues.

D3

Decompression
New sniff spot.

D4

Mix
Train then sniff break.

D5

Review
Which walk calmed most?



REVIEW · REFLECT

5 Common mistakes to avoid

AVOID THESE

- Using enrichment only when the dog is already destructive.
- Puzzles that are too hard — frustration, not fulfillment.
- Every walk is a strict heel — no sniff time at all.

If this happens, try this

IF THIS HAPPENS, TRY THIS

• Dog makes little progress or use higher-value food.
 • Still stuck after enrichment — tired, fulfilled.
 • Still stuck difficulty. Contact Fitdog if safety is a concern.

6 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can explain "Better Walks Through Sniffing" clearly.
- ☐ I added at least one new enrichment activity this week.
- ☐ I ended sessions while my dog was still engaged.
- ☐ My dog had daily outlets for sniffing, chewing, or problem-solving.

Take one structured walk and one decompression walk. Compare your dog's energy and calm afterward.

Which walk type left my dog more settled?

Where can I add more sniff time on our route?

Questions for my Fitdog trainer:

WELFARE / SAFETY

Supervise new enrichment setups. Remove items your dog could swallow or destroy unsafely.